

PICKING THE WINNERS

The methodology used for the *Business Today*-KPMG Best Banks and NBFCs Survey 2022-23

BY TEAM BT AND KPMG

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THE BANKING AND financial services industry (BFSI) was in robust health in 2022-23. This is the backdrop in which the *Business Today*-KPMG jury met to pick the winners in the banking and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) categories for 2022-23. It covered quantitative metrics as well as qualitative inputs to assess the performance.

The exercise took about six months, with KPMG, the knowledge partner, ensuring robust evaluations. This year's survey marked a significant addition of large NBFCs. KPMG reached out to more than 50 banks, 100 NBFCs, and fintech companies.

A high-powered jury, led by Anand Sinha, former Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India; and comprising NSE MD & CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan; Pallav Mohapatra, MD & CEO of asset reconstruction company

ARCIL; Rajiv Kaul, Executive Vice Chairman & CEO of business services company CMS Info Systems; Ranu Vohra, Co-founder & Executive Vice Chairman of financial services firm Aventus; and N.S. Kannan, former ED of ICICI Bank.

Discussions for the Bank of the Year award proved challenging, with HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank emerging as front-runners. After carefully considering the strengths and challenges both lenders faced, the jury voted for a joint award. But elsewhere, the decision was unanimous. This was in bestowing the Lifetime Achievement Award upon Uday Kotak, Founder and Director of Kotak Mahindra Bank. In all, the jury decided 11 winners in 10 award categories. There are also six winners based on a quantitative study.

QUANTITATIVE AWARDS

For rankings based on financial performance, data was taken from annual reports for FY20 to FY23. The survey covered 53 commer-

cial banks that published annual reports in the public domain or provided them before November 30, 2023. Foreign banks with a balance sheet size of less than ₹25,000 crore as on March 31, 2023, were not considered. Also not covered were banks that had not completed four years of operations in India as on March 31, 2023, or were involved in mergers in the last three years, or were under liquidation.

The ranking process

The banks were divided between 'Indian banks' (public and private sector banks), 'foreign banks' (branches of foreign banks operat-

